AI FOR MANAGERS · STUDY GUIDE

How to Assess Your Team's AI Use

How do I get a clear picture of what's actually happening in my team?

MODULE 2 · LESSON 3 | THE NEW PERFORMANCE PROBLEM | Action lesson · 10–13 min

THE CORE IDEA

You cannot manage what you have not made visible.

The AI Baseline Assessment replaces assumptions with evidence – a written picture of your team's actual AI use, captured as your Team AI Baseline.

1 From open questions to a real picture

The last two lessons left three questions open: which outputs involved AI, whether you could trace what happened, and what "reviewed" means when AI is in the process. For most managers the honest answer to at least one is no – and none of it can be fixed until you can see what your team is doing. This lesson is the how: a structured set of questions, in the right sequence, that make visible what AI has made invisible. The written record is the **Team AI Baseline** – the output of Assess, which the rest of the framework builds on.

2 The four areas of the AI Baseline Assessment

Each area makes the process layer visible – the part AI has changed in ways the finished work doesn't show.

Usage – what is actually happening

Which tools each person uses, for which tasks, how often – and which tasks they avoid AI for, and why. The factual foundation.

Impact – what has changed

What's faster, where quality has shifted, what time goes to now, what has dropped away. Watch for separate steps collapsing into one AI-assisted step – the informal checks inside them collapse too.

Capability – what AI use means for development

Which skills are used more, which less; if AI vanished for a week, what would feel hardest; can they walk through the reasoning without the document. This answers the attribution question – the line between person, tool, and what may be weakening.

Risk – where the exposure is

What information they're unsure about putting into tools, what they do before using or sending AI output, whether a consistent checking process exists.

3 Two things before you start

Start with yourself. Run the assessment on your own work first – which tools, which tasks, what has changed, where your own risks are. You are doing what you ask of them – and it surfaces your own blind spots first.

Frame it for your team. Without context, asking about AI use can feel like surveillance; with framing, it becomes an invitation. Before conversations start, tell the team what you are doing and why, what you will do with the information, and what it is *not* – not an audit, not about catching people out, not about restricting

how they work. Framing gets honest answers; skipping it gets guarded ones, and a picture that doesn't reflect reality.

4 The default gathering path

Written check-in → one-to-one follow-up → team-level pattern discussion → optional working alongside. Start in writing: low friction, time to think – and where trust is still forming, asking in writing beats asking in front of the room. Follow up in one-to-ones where you need depth, especially on capability and risk. Use the group session for patterns only, never individual profiles; voluntary show-and-tell works once trust is established. Working alongside someone gives the most accurate picture but stays optional.

5 What it produces: the Team AI Baseline

For each person, summarize what you found across the four areas – **Usage, Impact, Capability, Risk** – plus brief notes, on a simple three-point scale: ●○○ limited, ●●○ developing, ●●● strong. This is **not a performance rating** – it is your current snapshot, and the blanks you can't fill are findings in themselves. Then fill in a team row: the lowest-scoring areas are where you are most exposed right now. The team row can be shared – it shows the overall picture without exposing anyone's profile, and makes the need for a shared standard tangible from within the team. Written down, the baseline is something you can return to and update; writing up the summaries is itself a good low-stakes AI task, within your organization's data rules.

6 Optional add-on: the AI Opportunity Scan

If your baseline comes back nearly empty, first check whether low use is real or just unsurfaced – invisible use is more common than absence. If it is genuinely low, ask each person three light questions: which tasks are repetitive, where gathering information takes significant time before the actual thinking, and what feels slow or effortful out of proportion to the output. Filter the raw list with one impact question – *if we improved this, would it materially help the team or the work?* – and keep only the shortlist. Don't choose tools yet. The baseline captures current reality; the scan previews potential – a direction instead of a blank page. Teams further along do opportunity-finding later, in the Lead move.

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY AFTER THIS LESSON

- Run the **AI Baseline Assessment** with your team this week – written check-in first, then depth where needed.
- Run it on yourself before anyone else – you're joining, not auditing.
- Send the framing message before any conversations start: what you're doing, why, and what it is not.
- Write the results down as your **Team AI Baseline** – per person and a team row across Usage, Impact, Capability, and Risk.
- Share the team row with the team – it makes the case for a shared standard better than an announcement can.

Module 2 · The New Performance Problem – this module runs the Assess move; it is done when your Team AI Baseline exists. Download with this lesson: Handout B – Assess Question Prompts (the full set of question prompts). **Next: Module 3, Lesson 3.1 – You Have a Picture, You Don't Have a Standard** – the Align move begins: what you do with the picture.